Anhui Huang

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Education

2020-27 **University of California, Berkeley**
Ph.D. (expected), Philosophy
Dissertation: *Settled Questions, Certain Minds*
Committee: John MacFarlane (co-chair), Seth Yalcin (co-chair), Line Mikkelsen

> When you tell me you aren't sure who won the last Dutch election, it is natural for me to infer that you have *something* in mind that bears on the matter. This simple observation—that a denial of certainty seems to communicate that one has some opinion on the matter—has been overlooked in the literature on certainty. I argue that this phenomenon reveals a problem with the dominant view of certainty, which identifies it with maximal credence. I propose instead that certainty is taking inquiry into a question to be closed. This view explains the opinion inference and has several independent advantages: for example, because inquiry can be practical or theoretical, it explains how we can be certain about both decisions and judgments. It also yields a novel view of assertion: whereas certainty is taking one's own inquiry to be closed, assertion is a proposal to take collective inquiry to be closed.

2016-20 **Williams College**
B.A. Philosophy, with Honors & Phi Beta Kappa
Thesis: *How Explanations Explain*
Advisor: Bojana Mladenovic

2018–19 **Williams-Exeter Program at Oxford University**

Areas of Specialization

Epistemology, Philosophy of Language

Areas of Competence

Philosophy of Mind, Logic, Metaphysics, Decision Theory, Philosophy of Fiction, Early Modern

Publications

2021 "Mere Subjectivism? Kant's Transcendental Deduction and the Hegelian Criticism" (with Justin Shaddock)
Proceedings of the 13th International Kant Congress, pp. 651–658.

Work in Progress

"What It Takes to Be Sure" (under review)

"Collective Inquiry and Expiring Assertibility" (under review)

"Expressing Uncertainty" (under review)

"What Counts as Progress in Inquiry" (in progress)

"Fictions as Instructions" (in progress)

"When Authors are Bad Instructors" (in progress)

Talks

Invited Talks

"Certainty, Credence, and Inquiry"
Department Colloquium, Williams College — May 2026

Refereed Talks

"Certainty is not Credence One"
APA Eastern Division Meeting, Boston — January 2027 (scheduled)

"What It Takes to Be Sure"
Notre Dame/Northwestern Graduate Epistemology Conference, Notre Dame — May 2026

"Collective Inquiry and Expiring Assertion"
Central New York Philosophy of Language Workshop, Syracuse University — October 2025

"Certainty as Closed Inquiry: Explaining the Opinion Inference"
APA Pacific Division Meeting, San Francisco — April 2025

"Mere Subjectivism? Kant's Transcendental Deduction and the Hegelian Criticism"
International Kant Congress, Oslo (with Justin Shaddock) — August 2019

Commentaries

Comments on Bobby Brown's "A Four-Dimensional Descartes"
UC Santa Cruz Graduate Metaphysics Workshop, UC Santa Cruz — May 2026

Comments on John MacFarlane's "Disagreement and Meaning"
Kadish Workshop in Law, Philosophy, and Political Theory, UC Berkeley — September 2024

Fellowships and Awards

2025 — Dissertation Completion Fellowship, UC Berkeley
$39,000 stipend and coverage of tuition and fees

2020-23 — Regents Fellowship for Graduate Study, UC Berkeley
$35,000 stipend for 2 years and coverage of tuition and fees

2020 — Carol Lee Price Fellowship, UC Berkeley
Awarded annually by the philosophy department to one graduate student

2020	Versenyi Prize for Senior Going to Graduate School, Williams College *Awarded annually to one undergraduate going to graduate school*
2020	Miller Prize for Outstanding Senior in Philosophy, Williams College *Awarded annually by the philosophy department to one undergraduate student*
2019	Phi Beta Kappa, Williams College *Requires faculty recommendation; awarded to top 12.5% of the class*

Teaching

Primary Instructor

University of California, Berkeley

Summer 2024	The Nature of Mind

Assistant Instructor

University of California, Berkeley

Fall 2026	Existentialism in Film and Literature	Andreja Novakovic
Spring 2026	Probability and Induction	Snow Zhang
Spring 2025	Philosophical Methods	Shamik Dasgupta
Spring 2024	Philosophical Methods	Shamik Dasgupta
Fall 2023	Philosophy of Language	Seth Yalcin
Fall 2022	Introduction to Logic	Seth Yalcin
Summer 2022	Introduction to Logic	Erica Klempner
Spring 2022	Philosophical Methods	Geoffrey Lee
Fall 2021	The Nature of Mind	John Campbell

Williams College

Fall 2019	Personal identity	Bojana Mladenovic
Spring 2018	History of Modern Philosophy	Justin Shaddock

Sinoway International Summer School, Shanghai

Summer 2017	Introduction to Philosophy	Keith McPartland
Summer 2017	Classical Western Philosophy	Keith McPartland

Service

2023-present	Minorities and Philosophy UC Berkeley Chapter Coordinator
2025-present	Epistemology Reading Group Organizer
2023-26	Wellness Committee, Graduate Student Social Events Organizer
2023-25	Philosophy of Language Reading Group Organizer
2022-23	Department Colloquia Graduate Organizer
2020-21	Organizer, PhilGem: Forum for Women and Gender Minorities in Philosophy

Graduate Coursework

Qualifying Exams

Spring 2023	Fiction	Olivia Bailey
Spring 2023	Disagreement	John MacFarlane
Spring 2023	Lying	Seth Yalcin

Courses

** = audited; all others for credit.*

Fall 2026	Knowledge and Belief*	Veronica Gomez & Snow Zhang
Spring 2026	Explaining Action*	Seth Yalcin
Spring 2026	Metaphysics and Epistemology of Probability*	Ezra Rubenstein & Snow Zhang
Spring 2024	Belief*	John MacFarlane
Fall 2023	Contextualism*	Seth Yalcin
Spring 2023	Sellars*	John MacFarlane
Fall 2022	Information and Knowledge*	Seth Yalcin
Spring 2022	18th Century Sentimentalism	Olivia Bailey
Spring 2022	Thought, Character, and Action in Aristotle	Timothy Clarke
Fall 2021	Population Ethics	Johann Frick
Fall 2021	The Common Ground	John MacFarlane & Seth Yalcin
Spring 2021	Theory of Meaning*	John Campbell
Spring 2021	Belief, Credence, and Reasons*	John MacFarlane
Spring 2021	Imagination and Its Morals	Olivia Bailey
Spring 2021	Pragmatism	Shamik Dasgupta
Fall 2020	Modal Logic	Wesley Holliday
Fall 2020	Philosophy of Language*	Seth Yalcin
Fall 2020	Conditionals*	Seth Yalcin
Fall 2020	First-Year Seminar	John Campbell & Hannah Ginsborg